

Species: PURPLE FINCH

(Vernacular Name)

Cardinalis purpureus

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): December 6, 1975

Time Bird Seen: 9:50 A.M. to 9:55 A.M. - MST

Locality: Chautauqua Park (Bluebell Canyon)

Nearest Town: Boulder

County: Boulder

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME

ADDRESS

TELEPHONE

None

Optical Equipment: _____

If photographed, type of equipment used: _____

Light Conditions: Clear, bright

Distance from bird (how measured): 20 feet above me in a locust tree.

Number of Birds Seen: One Sex: Female Plumage: Adult

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

Feeding on seeds in the company of 15 House Finches.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern. Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

Small finch (5 1/2"-6"). Pale, conical shaped bill. Head prominently marked with conspicuous white eyeline, dark jaw stripe and ear patch. Dark brownish, blurred effect, breast markings. Under-tail coverts whitish, unmarked, clearly seen from below and well studied as bird perched directly above me in locust tree. Tail, notched. Upper parts, brownish. (not clearly discernable from birds position to me).

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

No song heard, but when finch flew away it gave several sharp calls - "peck" --- "peck" --- "peck".

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

Foothills canyon, heavily covered with scrub oak, underbrush.

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

Cassin's Finch (♀): Much less boldly marked head; breast markings very well-defined, much sharper than those of Purple Finch. Both male and female Cassin's Finch have faintly marked under tail coverts. Flight call much different from Purple Finch.

House Finch (♀): Head markings non-descript. Different bird altogether from Purple and Cassin's Finches

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

Have seen numerous Purple Finches in Chicago and on Long Island, New York. Seen Cassin's Finches in Washington, Arizona and Colorado since 1961. Considerable experience with House Finches from New York City area, California, Washington, Arizona and Colorado.

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

Birds of North America Robbins
Field Guide to Western Birds, Peterson
Finches, Sparrows, Buntings, etc, Bent

This report was written from notes made during x after x observation; from memory

PRINT NAME: JACK REDDALL SIGNATURE: Jack Reddall DATE: 1-1-76
Street Address: 4450 South Alton Street Town and State: Englewood Colo. ZIP: 80110

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110